



DRAGONSFALL

A CAMPAIGN SETTING FOR DUNGEONS & DRAGONS 5th EDITION



THE GREATEST HEROES IN HISTORY
SAVED THE WORLD...
AND THEN DISAPPEARED.

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DUNGEONS & DRAGONS

*“The Greatest Heroes in History Saved the World...
...And Then Disappeared.”*

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This document is an original homebrew campaign setting created for personal use.

Inspired by *Final Fantasy* and the *Forgotten Realms* campaign setting.

Created using Homebrewery.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

FRONT MATTER

Introduction	5
Running Dragonsfall	6
Campaign Overview (Phases I—V)	7

PART I — THE WORLD

The World After Tiamat	xx
Port Jeuno	xx
The Sea of Swords	xx
Ships of Dragonsfall	xx

PART II — THE PEOPLE

Major NPCs	xx
Captain Garland	xx

PART III — BEHIND THE CURTAIN

The Ark Angels	xx
Crystal Orbs & Dragon Lairs	xx
Timeline	xx

PART IV — RUNNING THE CAMPAIGN

Running the Adventure	xx
Session One	xx

APPENDIX

Treasure Tables	xx
Random Encounters	xx
Rumors	xx
Shop Inventories	xx
Weather at Sea	xx
Random Islands	xx
Dragon Hoards	xx
Magic Items	xx

INTRODUCTION



“THE DRAGONS ARE GONE, THE HEROES HAVE VANISHED, AND THE SEAS BELONG TO ANYONE BRAVE ENOUGH to chase what was left behind.”
— A common saying in Port Jeuno

WELCOME TO DRAGONSFALL

Dragonsfall is a long-form naval adventure campaign set in Faerûn one year after the defeat of Tiamat. Five legendary heroes saved the world from the Dragon Queen and disappeared shortly afterward, leaving no explanation behind.

In the months that followed, dragons across the world began to vanish. Ancient lairs fell silent, great shadows disappeared from the skies, and enormous hoards of gold and magical relics were left seemingly unguarded.

This sudden change has ushered in a new age of exploration. Pirates, treasure hunters, mercenaries, merchants, and naval powers now race across the Sea of Swords in search of forgotten dragon lairs and unimaginable riches.

The campaign begins in **Port Jeuno**, a young neutral harbor city built at the center of this treasure rush. The characters arrive as unknown adventurers seeking work, fortune, purpose, or escape. Their first opportunities will take them aboard the **Komatsu**, commanded by former naval captain **Beatrix** and her lifelong first mate **Steiner**.

What begins as a life of sailing, treasure hunting, rival crews, and dangerous exploration will gradually uncover mysteries connected to the fall of Tiamat, the disappearance of the legendary heroes, and the growing corruption spreading from the frozen north.

CAMPAIGN AT A GLANCE

System	Adaptable for multiple Rulesets
Starting Level	1
Expected Final Level	Approximately 20
Party Size	4–7 players
Primary Setting	Sea of Swords and Sword Coast
Campaign Style	Naval exploration, treasure hunting, and mystery

CAMPAIGN PILLARS

ADVENTURE

Explore islands, ruins, ports, shipwrecks, caves, and forgotten dragon lairs.

SAILING

Ships are more than transportation; they are home, livelihood, and freedom.

TREASURE

Wealth earns ships, crews, influence, information, and opportunity.

MYSTERY

Ancient secrets slowly reveal the truth behind the Dragonsfall.

CHOICE

The players decide where to sail, who to trust, and what kind of legends they become.

TONE

Dragonsfall should feel adventurous before it feels tragic.

The early campaign emphasizes freedom, discovery, dangerous seas, strange islands, rival captains, and the excitement of returning to Jeuno with a damaged ship and a hold full of treasure.

The darker mystery should remain beneath the surface until the players have grown attached to the world, the **Komatsu**, and the people whose lives were changed by the Dragonsfall.



WHAT THE CHARACTERS KNOW

At the beginning of the campaign, the characters generally know:

- Tiamat was defeated one year ago.
- Five legendary heroes were credited with saving Faerûn.

- Those heroes vanished after the final battle.
- Dragons have since disappeared or died across much of the world.
- Their abandoned hoards have triggered a massive treasure rush.
- Port Jeuno is neutral ground where crews trade maps, relics, information, and contracts.
- Some treasure expeditions have begun returning with disturbing stories.

RUNNING DRAGONSFALL

GUIDANCE FOR THE DUNGEON MASTER

Dragonsfall is designed as a sandbox adventure supported by a central long-term narrative.

The players should feel free to pursue rumors, accept contracts, search for treasure, form alliances, build rivalries, or simply sail toward the horizon. Although the campaign contains major story milestones, it should not feel as though the characters are being pulled directly from one predetermined event to the next.

Let the players wander. Let them fail. Let them become attached to their ship, their crew, and Port Jeuno. The deeper story will have far greater impact once they care about the world threatened by it.

THE JOURNEY

Character Level	Campaign Focus
1–5	Unknown treasure hunters
6–10	Experienced sailors
11–15	Renowned captains
16–20	Legends confronting the fate of Faerûn
20+	The Path to Ascension

USING THIS BOOK

This guide is organized to introduce the setting first, followed by its people, locations, ships, and adventures before gradually revealing the campaign's deepest mysteries.

The early chapters explain the world as it is commonly understood and may be useful when preparing player-facing material. Later sections contain information intended only for the Dungeon Master.

INSPIRATIONS

Dragonsfall draws inspiration from naval fantasy, treasure-hunting adventures, the *Forgotten Realms*, and the worlds and characters of the *Final Fantasy* series while telling its own campaign story.

DM SECRET

The world believes the five heroes who defeated Tiamat simply disappeared after the final battle.

In truth, they sacrificed dragonkind and began transforming themselves into beings known as the **Ark Angels**.

This secret forms the central mystery of the campaign and should be revealed gradually through rumors, recovered memories, ancient dragon lairs, Captain Garland, forgotten records, and the five crystal orbs.



CAMPAIGN OVERVIEW

Dragonsfall is a campaign of evolving scope.

What begins as a simple hunt for treasure among abandoned dragon lairs gradually becomes a story of exploration, rival captains, political intrigue, forgotten history, and the fate of Faerûn itself. Rather than rushing toward a single objective, the campaign is designed to grow naturally alongside the characters, allowing them to build reputations, forge alliances, command ships, and establish lives upon the sea before the world's greatest mysteries begin to unfold.

Every voyage offers opportunities for discovery. A routine treasure contract may uncover an ancient ruin. A chance encounter with a rival crew may shape the political landscape of the Sea of Swords. A forgotten map may lead not only to unimaginable riches, but to answers that have remained hidden since the fall of Tiamat.

The campaign rewards curiosity, exploration, and player choice. Decisions made during the earliest adventures may echo throughout the entire journey, ensuring that every crew's story becomes uniquely their own.

THE STRUCTURE OF THE CAMPAIGN

Although every group will forge its own path, *Dragonsfall* naturally unfolds in five broad stages. The pacing of these stages should remain flexible, allowing the players' decisions and interests to determine when the story moves forward.

Each stage introduces new opportunities, challenges, and revelations. The characters begin as humble treasure hunters searching for fortune upon the Sea of Swords, but the scope of their adventures steadily expands until they stand among the greatest legends in the history of Faerûn.

PHASE I — THE TREASURE RUSH

Recommended Levels: 1–5

The world feels limitless, and every treasure map promises the adventure of a lifetime.

The campaign begins in **Port Jeuno**, where rumors of abandoned dragon hoards have drawn sailors, adventurers, merchants, pirates, and opportunists from across Faerûn.

The characters begin as unknowns. Their first goals are simple: find work, earn coin, survive dangerous voyages, and build a reputation upon the Sea of Swords.

Most adventures during this stage revolve around:

- Following treasure maps
- Exploring minor dragon lairs
- Competing with rival treasure hunters
- Surviving dangerous islands
- Adjusting to shipboard life
- Building relationships with crews and captains

PHASE II — THE SEA BECKONS

Recommended Levels: 6–10

The horizon grows wider, but so does the realization that every discovery carries consequences.

By this stage, the characters are no longer unknown adventurers. Their successes have earned them recognition among the captains, merchants, pirates, and treasure hunters who sail the Sea of Swords.

The manner in which the characters earn this reputation shapes how they are viewed throughout the region. Heroes may be welcomed in one port, feared in another, and distrusted by those whose ambitions they have threatened. Although **Port Jeuno** remains neutral ground, neutrality does not imply friendship. Merchants, pirates, nobles, and captains remember the actions of those they meet.

Reputation becomes one of the campaign's most valuable currencies.

As the characters' influence grows, opportunities once reserved for veteran crews begin to appear. Expeditions venture farther from civilization, rival captains compete for increasingly valuable discoveries, and powerful factions seek capable crews to investigate islands from which few sailors have ever returned.

Although treasure remains the driving force behind most expeditions, observant characters begin noticing that many discoveries share unsettling connections. Strange symbols appear within forgotten ruins. Ancient records contradict accepted history. Survivors return with impossible stories. What first seemed like isolated mysteries slowly reveal themselves to be fragments of something far older and far more dangerous.

This stage should still preserve the campaign's sense of freedom. Characters are encouraged to pursue rumors, explore uncharted waters, improve their ships, recruit capable allies, and develop lasting rivalries.

By the end of this stage, the characters should no longer feel like passengers upon the Sea of Swords. Their decisions influence trade, politics, rivalries, and the fortunes of those who sail beside them. The world begins to change in response to their actions.

PHASE II — THE SEA BECKONS

ADVENTURES, OPPORTUNITIES, AND MILESTONES

TYPICAL ADVENTURES

- Leading large-scale treasure expeditions
- Exploring uncharted islands and caves
- Fighting naval battles against rival crews
- Escorting merchants and diplomats
- Recovering ancient artifacts
- Investigating abandoned dragon lairs
- Building influence within Port Jeuno

NEW OPPORTUNITIES

During this stage, the characters may begin to:

- Acquire larger or more specialized vessels
- Command their own crews
- Earn the trust of influential factions
- Establish long-term allies and rivals
- Become figures of renown—or infamy—throughout the Sea of Swords

GOALS FOR THE DM

During this stage, broaden the players' horizons without taking away their freedom. Continue rewarding exploration, reputation, and initiative while introducing subtle connections between otherwise unrelated discoveries.

The central mystery should become more visible, but it should not yet dominate the campaign. Treasure hunting, ship upgrades, crew relationships, and rival captains should remain important parts of play.

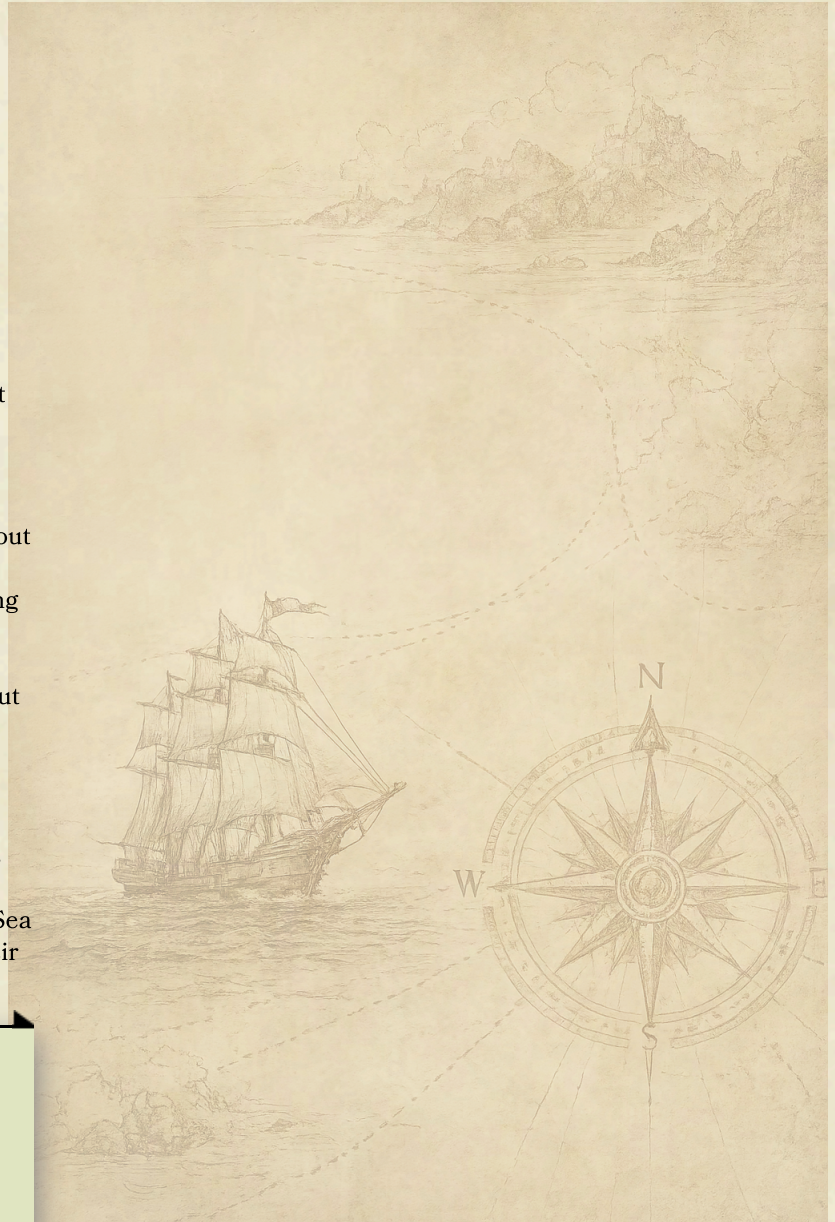
By the end of this stage, the characters should feel established within the Sea of Swords. The characters should feel like captains of their own destiny. Their reputations precede them, their decisions shape the Sea of Swords, and the world has begun to respond to their actions.

PHASE II MILESTONE

Before moving into the next stage, the characters should ideally have accomplished several of the following:

- Earned a recognizable reputation
- Formed at least one lasting alliance
- Established at least one meaningful rivalry
- Improved or acquired a significant vessel
- Discovered evidence that several mysteries are connected

These milestones are guidelines rather than strict requirements. Advance the campaign when the characters feel established upon the Sea of Swords and the deeper mystery is ready to take greater prominence.



PHASE II — THE SEA BECKONS

ADVANCEMENT, MYSTERY, REPUTATION, AND FACTION INVOLVEMENT

SIGNS THE CAMPAIGN IS READY TO ADVANCE

Consider advancing the campaign to its next stage when several of the following are true:

- The crew has become well known throughout the Sea of Swords.
- Treasure alone is no longer the characters' primary motivation.
- Rival captains have become recurring figures.
- The players have begun asking questions the world cannot answer.
- Ancient discoveries increasingly point toward the same forgotten history.

During this stage, the campaign should answer small questions while introducing larger ones. The players should begin recognizing patterns without yet understanding their significance. Curiosity—not certainty—should drive the story forward.

AVOID REVEALING TOO MUCH

The **Ark Angels** should remain legends.

Garland should still be viewed as an enigma.

The true fate of dragonkind should remain hidden.

The players should suspect that something is wrong without yet understanding what it is.

REPUTATION IN ACTION

A crew's reputation should have meaningful consequences. Characters who become respected, feared, or infamous should find that the world responds differently to their actions. A respected crew might receive:

- Discounts from merchants
- Invitations to noble estates
- Better contracts
- Loyal recruits

An infamous crew might instead receive:

- Fear and intimidation
- Easier access to pirates
- Suspicious city guards
- Bounties placed upon them

FACTION INVOLVEMENT

As the characters' reputation grows, powerful organizations begin taking notice. Merchant guilds,

noble houses, naval powers, scholars, religious orders, and secret societies may all have reasons to seek capable adventurers.

Some factions pursue wealth. Others seek knowledge. A select few know fragments of truths that the rest of the world has long forgotten.

A LIVING CAMPAIGN

Dragonsfall is not intended to rush from one major story event to the next. The Sea of Swords should feel alive, with opportunities constantly emerging beyond the central narrative.

Some of the campaign's greatest moments will come from voyages, rivalries, storms, and discoveries that were never part of the original plan. Encourage the players to leave the charted course. Often, that is where the best stories are found.

When the players choose an unexpected course, let the world respond naturally. The Sea of Swords should always feel larger than the adventure waiting in the next chapter.

PHASE III — ECHOES OF THE PAST

Recommended Levels: 11–15

The greatest treasures are no longer measured in gold, but in forgotten truths.

By now, the characters have become respected captains, accomplished explorers, and seasoned adventurers. Their reputations carry weight throughout the Sea of Swords, and the world has begun to recognize their accomplishments.

Yet the greatest discoveries awaiting them are no longer buried beneath abandoned dragon hoards.

They are buried beneath history itself.

Ancient ruins reveal contradictions no scholar can explain. Survivors return with impossible stories. Dragon lairs contain relics that should not exist. Forgotten records speak of events that conflict with everything the modern world believes.

What once appeared to be isolated mysteries now begin converging toward a single, unsettling question:

WHAT TRULY HAPPENED AFTER TIAMAT'S DEFEAT?

The answer will not be found in treasure vaults alone. It lies hidden within forgotten temples, abandoned dragon lairs, crumbling kingdoms, and the fading memories of those who survived the end of an age.

ANCIENT HISTORY BEGINS TO AWAKEN

The world begins contradicting itself. Everything the characters believed they understood is called into question.

They begin to uncover:

- Signs of long-forgotten dragon civilizations
- Ruined temples once used by an ancient cult
- Tomes and records that contradict accepted history
- Maps depicting unfamiliar coastlines and lost lands
- Relics that should not exist within abandoned lairs

History itself becomes a form of treasure. Each discovery provides part of an answer while awakening new dangers and raising larger questions.

THE CRYSTAL ORBS

Ancient records speak of immense crystal spheres hidden within forgotten dragon lairs. Their true purpose remains uncertain, but surviving references associate them with impossible acts of magic, the disappearance of dragonkind, and power capable of changing the fate of the world.

The characters may first encounter an orb after navigating caves, tombs, ruined temples, and the lair of an ancient dragon. Those who study or attune to one may gain extraordinary power, but such power carries consequences. The magic contained within an orb can alter the mind, body, and spirit of anyone who handles it carelessly.

Knowledge of the orbs is rare. Only scattered scholars, secretive factions, and determined treasure hunters understand that they exist at all. For those who believe the stories, the search becomes an obsession capable of driving them through every tomb, ruin, and forbidden place in their path.

Only one orb is rumored to have been recovered, though no one knows who possesses it.

CAPTAIN GARLAND THE FIERCE

Stories of **Captain Garland** spread across every port upon the Sea of Swords, though few can agree on which tales are true.

Garland is almost never seen without his full plate armor and heavy cloak. Few living souls claim to know what lies beneath either. His vessel, the **Pandemonium**, is built primarily from iron and steel and is capable of both sailing the sea and rising into the sky.

The sight of the Pandemonium inspires fear among the people of Port Jeuno and the treasure hunters who cross its path.

"Captain Garland was here. His crew reached the ruins before us. They took something."

— A frightened pirate

Whether Garland is friend or foe has yet to be determined. One fact remains certain: when Captain Garland appears, something important is never far away.

THE WORLD BEGINS TO CHANGE

As the characters uncover more of the mystery, the world begins responding.

Magical storms appear without warning.

Undead dragons are discovered within lairs long believed abandoned.

Islands absent from every known chart emerge from unnatural mists.

Ancient wards that protected the Sword Coast for centuries begin to fail.

Entire ships and crews vanish without explanation.

The excitement of the treasure rush slowly gives way to fear. Taverns grow quieter. Captains begin refusing voyages they once would have accepted without hesitation. Superstitions return, and even experienced sailors avoid waters where expeditions have disappeared.

Soon, the goal changes.

It is no longer only about finding treasure.

It is about finding answers.

The characters may seek scholars, explore forgotten ruins, investigate magical anomalies, destroy maddened undead dragons, or follow Captain Garland's trail. Whatever course they choose, they should begin to suspect that Garland knows far more than he is willing to reveal.



PHASE III — ECHOES OF THE PAST

OPPORTUNITIES, GUIDANCE, AND MILESTONES

THE POWERFUL COME CALLING

By this stage, the characters are renowned throughout the Sea of Swords. Whether they are celebrated, feared, or infamous, those with influence begin seeking their aid.

They may find themselves:

- Leading expeditions made up of multiple ships
- Receiving opportunities to influence kingdoms
- Negotiating with powerful factions
- Discovering their first Crystal Orb
- Challenging creatures once thought impossible
- Learning fragments of the truth behind the heroes who defeated Tiamat
- Being drawn into conflicts between scholars, nobles, navies, and secret societies

GOALS FOR THE DM

The players should spend time asking, *“How is this possible?”* before they begin saying, *“We have to stop this.”*

Allow them to speculate. Let them follow uncertain leads, reach incorrect conclusions, and discover that every answer creates new questions.

Captain Garland should remain mysterious. He is dangerous when provoked and should command respect long before the characters understand his motives.

Let the history of the world tell the story. Avoid delivering every revelation through NPC dialogue. Give the players journals to read, murals to interpret, statues to examine, dragon inscriptions to translate, and puzzles to solve.

History should be explored rather than explained.

The world should also feel ancient. By this stage, the campaign is no longer only about ports, pirates, and treasure. It is about civilizations lost for thousands of years and truths buried beyond living memory. Every ruin should feel older than the kingdoms built above it.

THE SEAS GROW QUIET

The treasure rush no longer feels as carefree as it once did.

Rumors spread faster than ships. Sailors refuse dangerous routes. Entire crews remain in port rather than risk waters associated with magical storms, undead dragons, or vanishing expeditions.

Fear should not replace adventure, but it should begin changing its meaning. The same horizon that once

promised riches now suggests that something ancient is awakening beyond it.

PHASE III MILESTONE

Before moving into the next stage, the characters should ideally have accomplished several of the following:

- Discovered the existence of the Crystal Orbs
- Learned that accepted history is not merely incomplete, but incorrect
- Encountered evidence of dragon corruption
- Crossed paths with Captain Garland or witnessed his influence
- Explored ruins older than any surviving kingdom
- Begun questioning everything they believed about Tiamat's defeat
- Realized that treasure is no longer the campaign's greatest reward

These milestones are guidelines rather than requirements. Advance the campaign when the characters are no longer searching primarily for wealth, but for the truth behind the Dragonsfall itself.